Setting Up Dad's Records, Contacts and Review Routine

Your family's part, in order, with a line for who does each action and by when.

The goal: Dad's records are where a second person can find them, your family knows who would handle what, the changes that may be coming are written down, and there's a date to look again.

It doesn't have to be a project. One small job at a time, on whatever Saturday suits Dad, gets it done. Put a name beside each action. “By when” can be a month or a season; nothing on this page has a deadline.

ACTION	WHO	BY WHEN	DONE
1. Ask Dad whether he's willing to do this together, and let him choose the day and the pace.			
2. Write down what your family has heard about what happens after a Medicaid approval: ongoing reviews, renewals, reporting changes. Mark each line “told”, “assuming” or “don't know”, and keep the last two kinds as questions.			
3. Gather Dad's financial records in one place, and note where new statements go as they arrive.			
4. Find his important legal documents and his care-related paperwork, and note where the signed originals are.			
5. Choose with Dad one safe place for all of it, on paper or online, and a second person he trusts who can reach it.			
6. Make a family contact list, and give everyone a copy.			
7. Write down who Dad would want managing Medicaid matters if benefits were ever needed, and who would back them up.			
8. List the professionals Dad already uses, and the kinds your family may need and hasn't found yet.			
9. Pick one folder and one calendar where official mail and dated reminders about Dad's affairs would go, so the habit is already there if it's ever needed.			
10. Write down the changes that may be coming, in his finances, in where he lives, or in money he might receive such as an inheritance, each with a question beside it.			
11. Agree as a family that a major financial transaction gets a question to a professional before it happens, and write down who would make that call.			

ACTION	WHO	BY WHEN	DONE
12. Choose a date to go over all of this again, and list the events that would bring you back sooner: a significant financial change, or a change in Dad's health or care.			

You're done when

Your family has a simple system for keeping things current: Dad's records are in one place a second person can reach, you know who would handle Medicaid matters if benefits ever became necessary, the changes that may be coming are written down with a question beside each, and there's a date to look again. What comes after that, a professional's review of the plan, the answers about what Dad's state requires, and any decision about his money, his property or his legal documents, isn't on this list, because it isn't the family's to do alone.

If a season gets away from you

- Don't fill a gap by guessing. “Don't know yet” is a finished line.
- If Dad would rather stop for now, stop. The list will keep.
- If a change comes up along the way, such as a sale, a move or money arriving, write it down, take the question to a professional before anyone acts, and carry on with the list.

What this plan doesn't do

It organizes your family's part. It doesn't say what Medicaid requires after an approval, whether any change would have to be reported, or whether Dad will ever need Medicaid, and it doesn't stand in for the professional review it prepares you for. Renewal, reporting and recordkeeping requirements vary by state and by case; bring those questions to your Medicaid planner or the appropriate licensed professional. Nothing here is legal, financial or tax advice.

Ready for the next step?

You've worked down your family's part one small job at a time, and there's a date to look again. The planning interview goes on from there: it asks about your family's situation and gives you a free planning report you can bring to any conversation about paying for care.

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